PRODUCTION BOOK

Nelly Go ’Cross the Ocean

a felt-puppet storybook stage · short educational video

key art · Nelly crosses the paper ocean

Pixar-polish, Henson-warm: every frame feels handmade.

PRODUCTION OVERVIEW

REV 01

A singing-game journey from Kathy Reid-Naiman’s “More Tickles and Tunes”, told on a miniature paper stage.

D01 / OVERALL DESIGN

Paper landscapes. Felt characters. Keep the handmade scale and material: tactile, delicate, playful. Soft studio light on a dimensional storybook stage. D01 governs every scene: nothing glossy, nothing digital-flat.

SHORT-VIDEO FORMAT

Short video (~1–2 min), 16:9, 1920×1080. One scene per lyric phrase; each scene teaches one idea (place, direction, action). Cues come from the checked transcript; lyrics are never paraphrased.

MASTER REFERENCE REGISTER

D01	**Overall design**	*paper landscapes · felt characters*	
L01	**Ocean Stage**	*original background · 1672×941*	
C01	**Nelly**	*character sheet › spread 3*	
C02	**Mouse**	*friend · shared cast*	
C03	**Fox**	*friend · shared cast*	
C04	**Bear**	*friend · shared cast*	

Every reference keeps its source, its prompt and its revision trail.

THE WORLD / L01

LOOK DEVELOPMENT

An ocean made of paper

Ocean Stage / original source · 1672 × 941 px

MATERIAL & SCALE

Felt characters on paper-cut scenery standing on an open storybook. Palette: cobalt, sky blue, gingham cream, warm walnut table. Scale: stage waves ~ 1/3 of the book width; characters stand ~1 book-page tall.

› *Keep the approved source with its prompt.*

REFERENCE REGISTER

L01 Ocean Stage
Source: stage-ocean-v1.png
Original: 1672 × 941 px · Scene composition: 1920 × 1080 px

EXACT LOCATION PROMPT

Dimensional paper-cut ocean stage on an open handmade storybook: layered cobalt and sky-blue waves with white foam curls, one gingham swell, cream paper tabs holding the cut-outs upright. Walnut tabletop, plain powder-blue backdrop, soft studio light, tactile, shallow depth, no text, no characters.

REVISION / REASON

v1 › composite: add Nelly on the open book; keep the stage unchanged. Selected result: scene-ocean-nelly.png. Earlier prompt kept; exact revision appended.

crop · 16:9

SOURCE : stage-ocean-v1

RESULT : SCENE 01

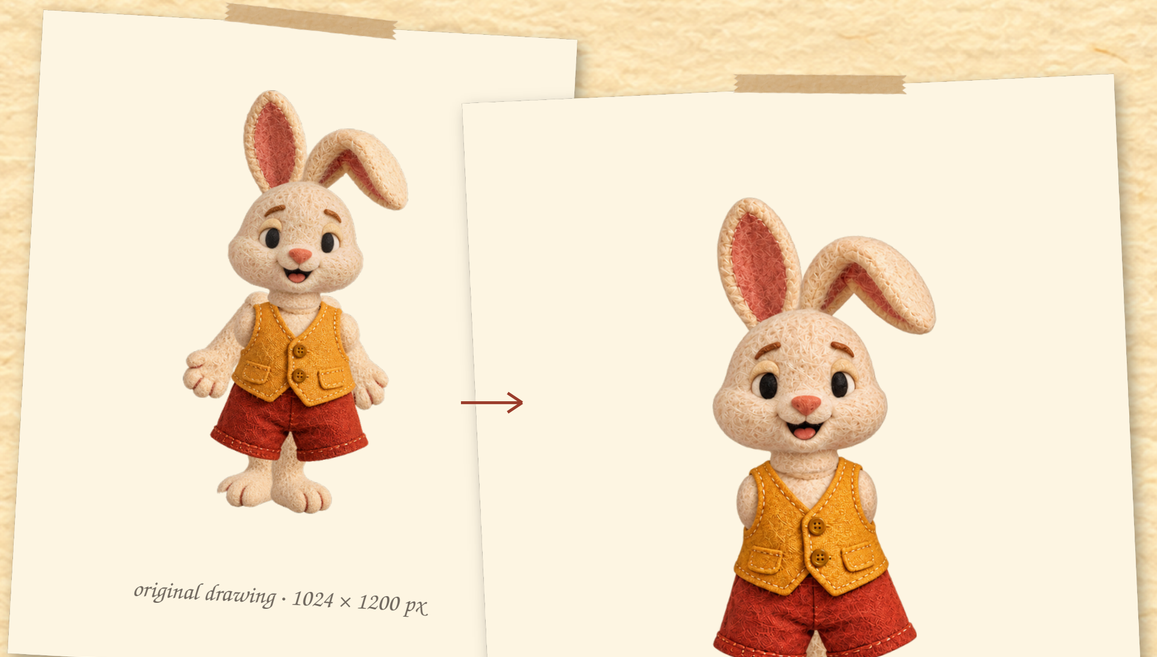
› *New art starts from this source and its references.*

Fit proportionally. Approve any crop. Never stretch.

CHARACTER / C01

CHARACTER STUDY

Original › animation pose



original drawing · 1024 × 1200 px

saved result · 1024 × 1536 px

› Same design. Clear limbs. Room to move.

C01 · NELLY · FELT RABBIT

SAVED EXACT PROMPT

Draw ONE image on a 1024 x 1536 px canvas.
Redraw the attached character exactly (same design, colours, clothing, materials) as one full-body front view, centred horizontally, about 1300 px tall, feet on a baseline at y = 1440.
Animation-ready stance: standing upright, feet planted shoulder-width apart with a clear gap of background between the legs from the crotch to the floor, arms held slightly away from the body (about 20 degrees) with a clear gap between each arm and the body, hands open, head level. Every limb is fully visible and not overlapping another limb.
Felt-plush storybook character art for 2D animation. Plain transparent background, no text, labels, frames, shadows or props. Nothing touches the canvas edge. Clean solid silhouette edge with no loose fibres or specks. Every drawing of the character keeps the same design, palette, proportions and scale.

canvas 1024 × 1536 (2:3)

SILHOUETTE RULES
limbs fully visible
no limb overlaps another
clear gap between legs
clear gap beside each arm
nothing touches canvas edge
no loose fibres or specks

Original drawing › generated asset
Generated and attached · visual review still required

GEOMETRY TO PRESERVE

2:3 canvas · 1024 × 1536 px · requested body ~ 1300 px · feet baseline y = 1440
Clean silhouette: limbs separated, no overlaps, nothing touches canvas edge.
Body size and baseline are requests, not measured output.

SCENE STUDY

CROSSING THE OCEAN

handmade production notebook
scene storyboard

SCENE 01 | Ocean Stage

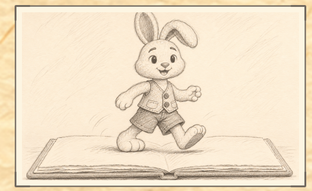
AUDIO / LYRIC CUE

“Nelly go cross the ocean / Nelly go cross the sea”

0:02.24 – 0:06.12

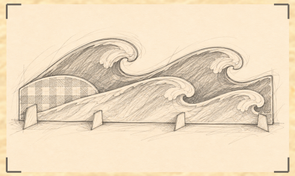
PURPOSE / LESSON

We learn the song’s first journey: Nelly sets out across big blue water.



STAGING CHECKLIST

- ☐ *hold on the waves*
- ☐ *Nelly enters from page left*
- ☐ *keep paper scale steady*



REFERENCE LIST

REV 01

OVERALL DESIGN	Paper landscapes. Felt characters. Keep the handmade scale and material: tactile, delicate, playful. Soft studio light on a dimensional storybook stage.
Location / original	S01 — Ocean Stage paper stage (L01 family), original plate stage-ocean-v1.png
Character / shared	Nelly — felt rabbit, yellow vest, red shorts; C01 shared across scenes.
Character / individual	Nelly (lead): animation-ready pose C01, front view, 1024×1536.
Asset geometry / props	Canvas 1920×1080 (16:9). Nelly body ~1300 px of 1536, feet y=1440; fit proportionally, never stretch.

crop (16:9)

SOURCE : OCEAN STAGE

RESULT : SCENE 01 (generated)

match framing & angle — add Nelly

EXACT PROMPT

Handmade felt-puppet storybook scene, 16:9. Nelly the felt rabbit (yellow vest, red shorts) on the open paper book stage, ocean stage backdrop. Keep the stage exactly as in the reference: dimensional paper-cut set, tactile felt, soft studio light, shallow depth, no text, no extra characters.

contact strip — alt takes / expression / timing

SCENE STUDY

UP THE MOUNTAIN

handmade production notebook
scene storyboard

SCENE 02 | Mountain Top

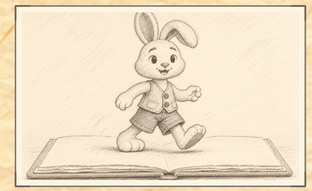
AUDIO / LYRIC CUE

“Nelly go cross the mountain top / But then come back to me”

0:06.76 – 0:10.10

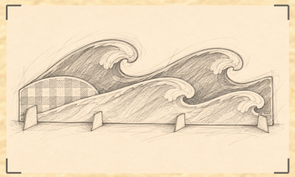
PURPOSE / LESSON

We hear “mountain top” and see up and back: a round trip.



STAGING CHECKLIST

- ☐ *climb a little, pause at the peak*
- ☐ *turn back toward the camera*
- ☐ *keep felt colours calm*

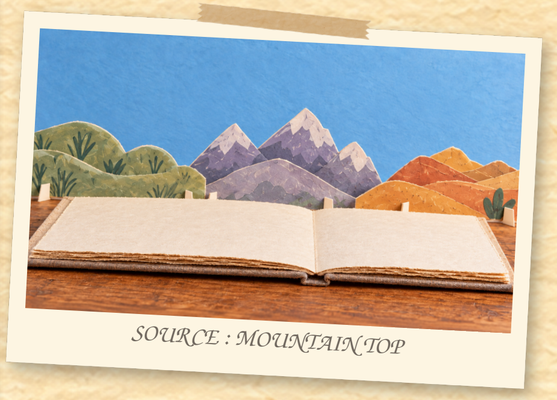


REFERENCE LIST

REV 01

OVERALL DESIGN	Paper landscapes. Felt characters. Keep the handmade scale and material: tactile, delicate, playful. Soft studio light on a dimensional storybook stage.
Location / original	S02 — Mountain Top paper stage (L01 family), original plate stage-mountain-v1.png
Character / shared	Nelly — felt rabbit, yellow vest, red shorts; C01 shared across scenes.
Character / individual	Nelly (lead): animation-ready pose C01, front view, 1024×1536.
Asset geometry / props	Canvas 1920×1080 (16:9). Nelly body ~1300 px of 1536, feet y=1440; fit proportionally, never stretch.

crop (16:9)



SOURCE : MOUNTAIN TOP

RESULT : SCENE 02 (generated)

match framing & angle — add Nelly

EXACT PROMPT

Handmade felt-puppet storybook scene, 16:9. Nelly the felt rabbit (yellow vest, red shorts) on the open paper book stage, mountain top backdrop. Keep the stage exactly as in the reference: dimensional paper-cut set, tactile felt, soft studio light, shallow depth, no text, no extra characters.

contact strip — alt takes / expression / timing

SCENE STUDY

ACROSS THE PRAIRIE

handmade production notebook
scene storyboard

SCENE 03 | Prairie

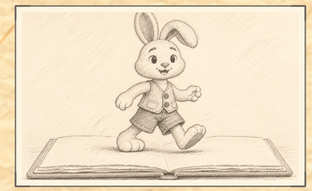
AUDIO / LYRIC CUE

“Nelly go cross the prairies / Nelly go cross the plain”

0:10.72 – 0:14.26

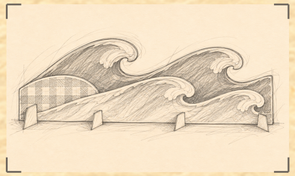
PURPOSE / LESSON

Wide open space is shown with a long, easy walk across flat land.



STAGING CHECKLIST

- ☐ *long steady take*
- ☐ *horizon line stays low*
- ☐ *no extra props*



REFERENCE LIST

REV 01

OVERALL DESIGN	Paper landscapes. Felt characters. Keep the handmade scale and material: tactile, delicate, playful. Soft studio light on a dimensional storybook stage.
Location / original	S03 — Prairie paper stage (L01 family), original plate stage-prairie-v1.png
Character / shared	Nelly — felt rabbit, yellow vest, red shorts; C01 shared across scenes.
Character / individual	Nelly (lead): animation-ready pose C01, front view, 1024×1536.
Asset geometry / props	Canvas 1920×1080 (16:9). Nelly body ~1300 px of 1536, feet y=1440; fit proportionally, never stretch.

crop (16:9)

SOURCE : PRAIRIE

RESULT : SCENE 03 (generated)

match framing & angle — add Nelly

EXACT PROMPT

Handmade felt-puppet storybook scene, 16:9. Nelly the felt rabbit (yellow vest, red shorts) on the open paper book stage, prairie backdrop. Keep the stage exactly as in the reference: dimensional paper-cut set, tactile felt, soft studio light, shallow depth, no text, no extra characters.

contact strip — alt takes / expression / timing

SCENE STUDY

OVER THE DESERT

handmade production notebook
scene storyboard

SCENE 04 | Desert Sands

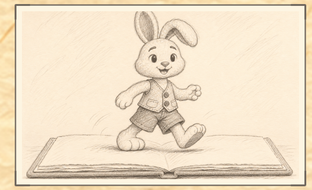
AUDIO / LYRIC CUE

“Nelly go cross the desert sands / And then come back again”

0:14.80 – 0:18.34

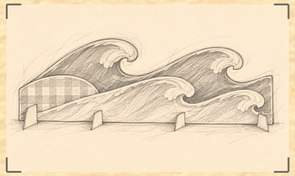
PURPOSE / LESSON

Warm dry sand sets a new place, then Nelly comes back again.



STAGING CHECKLIST

- ☐ *warm light only*
- ☐ *Nelly returns to start mark*
- ☐ *keep sand grain soft*



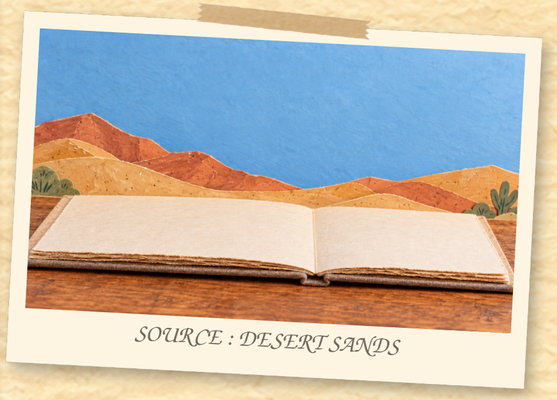
REFERENCE LIST

REV 01

OVERALL DESIGN Paper landscapes. Felt characters. Keep the handmade scale and material: tactile, delicate, playful. Soft studio light on a dimensional storybook stage.

Location / original	S04 — Desert Sands paper stage (L01 family), original plate stage-desert-v1.png
Character / shared	Nelly — felt rabbit, yellow vest, red shorts; C01 shared across scenes.
Character / individual	Nelly (lead): animation-ready pose C01, front view, 1024×1536.
Asset geometry / props	Canvas 1920×1080 (16:9). Nelly body ~1300 px of 1536, feet y=1440; fit proportionally, never stretch.

crop (16:9)



SOURCE : DESERT SANDS

RESULT : SCENE 04 (generated)

match framing & angle — add Nelly

EXACT PROMPT

Handmade felt-puppet storybook scene, 16:9. Nelly the felt rabbit (yellow vest, red shorts) on the open paper book stage, desert sands backdrop. Keep the stage exactly as in the reference: dimensional paper-cut set, tactile felt, soft studio light, shallow depth, no text, no extra characters.

contact strip — alt takes / expression / timing

SCENE STUDY

JUMP AND TURN

handmade production notebook
scene storyboard

SCENE 05 | Garden Jump

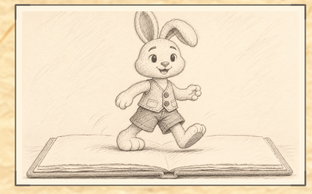
AUDIO / LYRIC CUE

“Nelly jump up and down now / Nelly jump up and down / Nelly turn round and round and round / And round and round and round and round”

0:18.78 – 0:26.80

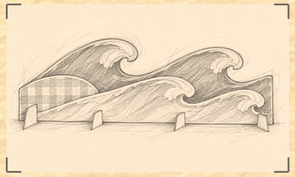
PURPOSE / LESSON

Movement words become actions: jump up and down, then turn round and round.



STAGING CHECKLIST

- ☐ *two small jumps*
- ☐ *slow turn, feet stay planted*
- ☐ *let the turn feel playful*



REFERENCE LIST

REV 01

OVERALL DESIGN — Paper landscapes. Felt characters. Keep the handmade scale and material: tactile, delicate, playful. Soft studio light on a dimensional storybook stage.

Location / original	S05 — Garden Jump paper stage (L01 family), original plate stage-garden-v1.png
Character / shared	Nelly — felt rabbit, yellow vest, red shorts; C01 shared across scenes.
Character / individual	Nelly (lead): animation-ready pose C01, front view, 1024×1536.
Asset geometry / props	Canvas 1920×1080 (16:9). Nelly body ~1300 px of 1536, feet y=1440; fit proportionally, never stretch.

crop (16:9)

SOURCE : GARDEN JUMP

RESULT : SCENE 05 (generated)

match framing & angle — add Nelly

EXACT PROMPT

Handmade felt-puppet storybook scene, 16:9. Nelly the felt rabbit (yellow vest, red shorts) on the open paper book stage, garden jump backdrop. Keep the stage exactly as in the reference: dimensional paper-cut set, tactile felt, soft studio light, shallow depth, no text, no extra characters.

contact strip — alt takes / expression / timing